

Engineering Document E07 — HQ Design Language Specification

Product Name: HQ

Engineering Package: Version 1.0

Purpose

The HQ Design Language Specification establishes the complete visual identity, interaction principles, and design token system for the HQ platform.

This document is the single source of truth for designers, frontend engineers, and AI-assisted development tools.

Every screen, component, animation, and interaction must conform to this specification.

Design Philosophy

HQ is not designed to look like another SaaS dashboard.

It should feel like entering a futuristic Executive Headquarters where intelligent systems coordinate complex work.

The interface should communicate:

- Intelligence
- Authority
- Confidence
- Precision
- Speed
- Calmness
- Professionalism

The UI should never feel noisy or overwhelming.

Brand Personality

HQ should be perceived as:

- Intelligent
- Executive
- Premium
- Trustworthy
- Innovative
- Human-centered
- Modern

Every visual decision reinforces these traits.

Core Design Principles

1. Clarity before decoration.
 2. Motion must communicate purpose.
 3. Data should be immediately understandable.
 4. AI should feel alive, not mysterious.
 5. Consistency outweighs novelty.
 6. Every interaction should build user confidence.
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Color System

Primary Brand Colors

- HQ Blue — Intelligence and trust
 - HQ Cyan — AI activity
 - HQ Purple — Innovation
 - HQ White — Clarity
 - HQ Graphite — Foundation
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Semantic Colors

Success

Warning

Error

Information

Neutral

Each semantic color includes:

- Background
- Surface
- Border
- Text
- Icon

AI System Colors

Planning

Thinking

Collaborating

Reviewing

Approved

Needs Revision

Completed

These colors visually communicate AI state throughout the platform.

Executive Department Colors

Each executive receives a consistent accent color.

Examples:

CEO

Chief of Staff

Marketing

Creative

Engineering

Finance

Legal

Operations

Research

Analytics

Security

Customer Success

These colors appear in avatars, timelines, graphs, and activity indicators.

Theme System

Support:

- Light Theme
- Dark Theme
- System Theme

All colors are defined using design tokens and CSS variables.

No component may hardcode color values.

Typography

Primary Font

Inter

Secondary Font

JetBrains Mono

Typography Scale

- Display XL
- Display L
- Heading 1
- Heading 2
- Heading 3
- Heading 4
- Body Large
- Body
- Body Small
- Caption
- Label

Typography should establish a clear visual hierarchy.

Grid System

HQ uses an 8-point spacing system.

Spacing tokens include:

- XS
- SM
- MD
- LG

- XL
- XXL

Layouts align consistently across all screens.

Border Radius

Standardized radius tokens:

- Small
- Medium
- Large
- Extra Large
- Pill
- Full Circle

Rounded corners communicate approachability while maintaining a professional appearance.

Elevation System

Surface hierarchy:

Level 0

Base Background



Level 1

Cards



Level 2

Panels



Level 3

Dialogs



Level 4

Floating Windows



Level 5

Critical Alerts

Elevation is created through shadows, blur, and contrast rather than excessive borders.

Iconography

Icons use:

- Lucide React

Standard sizes:

- XS
- SM
- MD
- LG
- XL

Stroke width remains consistent throughout the application.

Motion Language

Motion communicates intelligence.

Animations should never feel decorative.

Motion categories:

Navigation

State Changes

Loading

Executive Collaboration

Mission Progress

Notifications

Success

Errors

AI Motion Language

This is HQ's signature interaction system.

Instead of traditional loading indicators, users observe intelligent activity.

Examples:

Executive nodes activate.

Connection lines animate between departments.

The Chief of Staff delegates work.

The CEO reviews outputs.

Departments collaborate in real time.

Mission progress updates dynamically.

This transforms waiting into visible collaboration.

Executive Presence

Every executive has:

- Avatar
- Department color
- Status indicator
- Activity pulse
- Confidence level
- Availability state

Executives appear as living members of the organization rather than static icons.

Dashboard Language

The dashboard emphasizes:

- Clear hierarchy
- Actionable insights
- Minimal clutter
- Live executive activity
- Mission progress
- Organizational health

Users should understand the current state within seconds.

Data Visualization

Charts follow consistent standards.

Support:

- Line
- Bar
- Area
- Pie
- Timeline

- Heatmap

Every visualization uses the HQ color system and typography.

Component Tokens

Every component references shared design tokens.

Examples:

Buttons

Cards

Inputs

Sidebar

Executive Cards

Mission Cards

Dialogs

Tables

Badges

Charts

This ensures visual consistency across the platform.

Accessibility

The design system guarantees:

- WCAG-compliant contrast
- Keyboard accessibility
- Screen reader compatibility

- Reduced motion support
- Clear focus indicators
- Readable typography

Accessibility is considered from the beginning, not added later.

Responsive Principles

Layouts adapt gracefully across:

- Mobile
- Tablet
- Laptop
- Desktop
- Ultra-wide displays

Components maintain usability regardless of screen size.

Tailwind Token Mapping

All design decisions map to:

- CSS Variables
- Tailwind Theme
- shadcn/ui Configuration

Developers reference tokens rather than hardcoded values.

Future Evolution

The design language supports:

- White-label branding
- Enterprise themes
- Seasonal themes

- Additional executive departments
- New AI visualizations
- Mobile application
- Desktop application

The design system evolves without requiring widespread UI rewrites.

Success Criteria

The HQ Design Language succeeds when:

- Every screen feels unmistakably like HQ.
 - Users immediately recognize executive collaboration.
 - Components remain visually consistent.
 - Developers build quickly using reusable tokens.
 - The platform communicates intelligence, trust, and professionalism.
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Conclusion

The HQ Design Language Specification defines the visual identity of HQ.

By combining a unified design token system, premium interaction patterns, AI-specific motion language, and a scalable theming architecture, HQ establishes a recognizable and enduring product experience.

Rather than presenting AI as a simple chatbot, the design language reinforces HQ's vision: an intelligent Executive Headquarters where specialized AI leaders work together to accomplish meaningful work.